RUSSIAN REVOLUTION AND USSR UNDER STALIN

UNFINISHED REVOLUTION AFTER 1905 → WAR-TO-COLLAPSE CHAIN → DUAL-POWER MECHANISM → FEBRUARY VERSUS OCTOBER → PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT FAILURE → BOLSHEVIK CONSOLIDATION TOOLKIT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 — UNFINISHED REVOLUTION AFTER 1905

UNFINISHED REVOLUTION AFTER 1905 | DEFEAT BY JAPAN | UNREST AND OCTOBER MANIFESTO | PROMISED BUT FIRST TWO DISSOLVED | STOLYPIN REFORMS REACH TOO FEW | REGIME SURVIVES WITHOUT SOLVING LEGITIMACY

DEFEAT BY JAPAN → unrest and October Manifesto → DUMA → promised but first two dissolved → LAND → Stolypin reforms reach too few → RESULT → regime survives without solving legitimacy

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• DEFEAT BY JAPAN → unrest and October Manifesto	• LAND → Stolypin reforms reach too few	• DEFEAT BY JAPAN → unrest and October Manifesto
• DUMA → promised but first two dissolved	• RESULT → regime survives without solving legitimacy	• DUMA → promised but first two dissolved

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DEFEAT BY JAPAN → unrest and October Manifesto.

01

STAGE 01 — WAR-TO-COLLAPSE CHAIN

WAR-TO-COLLAPSE CHAIN | OLD WEAKNESS | AUTOCRACY, LAND AND LABOUR CONFLICT | WORLD WAR | DEFEAT, SHORTAGE AND TRANSPORT FAILURE | RIOTS, STRIKES AND MUTINY | 2 MARCH 1917 | NICHOLAS II ABDICATES

OLD WEAKNESS → autocracy, land and labour conflict → WORLD WAR → defeat, shortage and transport failure → PETROGRAD → riots, strikes and mutiny → 2 MARCH 1917 → Nicholas II abdicates

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• OLD WEAKNESS → autocracy, land and labour conflict	• PETROGRAD → riots, strikes and mutiny	• OLD WEAKNESS → autocracy, land and labour conflict
• WORLD WAR → defeat, shortage and transport failure	• 2 MARCH 1917 → Nicholas II abdicates	• WORLD WAR → defeat, shortage and transport failure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WORLD WAR → defeat, shortage and transport failure.

02

STAGE 02 — DUAL-POWER MECHANISM

DUAL-POWER MECHANISM | PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT | FORMAL STATE OFFICE | PETROGRAD SOVIET | SOLDIER AND WORKER LOYALTY | GOVERNMENT DELAYS DECISIONS | AUTHORITY EXISTS IN TWO INCOMPATIBLE CENTRES

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT → formal state office	WAR/LAND → government delays decisions	PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT → formal state office
PETROGRAD SOVIET → soldier and worker loyalty	RESULT → authority exists in two incompatible centres	PETROGRAD SOVIET → soldier and worker loyalty

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT → formal state office	• WAR/LAND → government delays decisions	• PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT → formal state office
• PETROGRAD SOVIET → soldier and worker loyalty	• RESULT → authority exists in two incompatible centres	• PETROGRAD SOVIET → soldier and worker loyalty

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → authority exists in two incompatible centres.

03

STAGE 03 — FEBRUARY VERSUS OCTOBER

FEBRUARY VERSUS OCTOBER | BROAD UPRISING AND TSARIST COLLAPSE | PREPARED BOLSHEVIK SEIZURE | NICHOLAS ABDICATES | MINISTERS ARRESTED, PARTY TAKES POWER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FEBRUARY → broad uprising and tsarist collapse	FEBRUARY → Nicholas abdicates	FEBRUARY → broad uprising and tsarist collapse
OCTOBER → prepared Bolshevik seizure	OCTOBER → ministers arrested, party takes power	OCTOBER → prepared Bolshevik seizure

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• FEBRUARY → broad uprising and tsarist collapse	• FEBRUARY → Nicholas abdicates	• FEBRUARY → broad uprising and tsarist collapse
• OCTOBER → prepared Bolshevik seizure	• OCTOBER → ministers arrested, party takes power	• OCTOBER → prepared Bolshevik seizure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FEBRUARY → Nicholas abdicates; OCTOBER → ministers arrested, party takes power.

04

STAGE 04 — PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT FAILURE

PROVISIONAL GOVERNMENT FAILURE | WAR CONTINUES | POPULAR SUPPORT FALLS | LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED | RURAL AND DEMOCRATIC TRUST FALLS | ECONOMIC LEGITIMACY COLLAPSES | BOLSHEVIKS GAIN ORGANISATIONAL PRESTIGE

WAR CONTINUES → popular support falls → LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED → rural and democratic trust falls → SHORTAGES → economic legitimacy collapses → KORNILOV → Bolsheviks gain organisational prestige

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• WAR CONTINUES → popular support falls	• SHORTAGES → economic legitimacy collapses	• WAR CONTINUES → popular support falls
• LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED → rural and democratic trust falls	• KORNILOV → Bolsheviks gain organisational prestige	• LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED → rural and democratic trust falls

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LAND/ELECTIONS DELAYED → rural and democratic trust falls.

05

STAGE 05 — BOLSHEVIK CONSOLIDATION TOOLKIT

BOLSHEVIK CONSOLIDATION TOOLKIT | LAND AND WORKER MEASURES | EXIT WAR | BREST-LITOVSK, MARCH 1918 | ASSEMBLY DISPERSED, CHEKA AND RED TERROR | CIVIL WAR VICTORY THEN NEP

DECREE → land and worker measures

EXIT WAR → Brest-Litovsk, March 1918 → COERCION → Assembly dispersed, Cheka and Red Terror → SURVIVAL → Civil War victory then NEP

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• DECREE → land and worker measures	• COERCION → Assembly dispersed, Cheka and Red Terror	• DECREE → land and worker measures
• EXIT WAR → Brest-Litovsk, March 1918	• SURVIVAL → Civil War victory then NEP	• EXIT WAR → Brest-Litovsk, March 1918

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COERCION → Assembly dispersed, Cheka and Red Terror.

06

STAGE 06 — WHY THE REDS WON

WHY THE REDS WON | LENIN AND TROTSKY FIRMER | CENTRAL RUSSIAN CORE CONTROLLED | WHITES DIVIDED IN AIM | REDS CLAIM DEFENCE OF RUSSIA

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer	OPPONENT → Whites divided in aim	LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer
GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled	INTERVENTION → Reds claim defence of Russia	GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer	• OPPONENT → Whites divided in aim	• LEADERSHIP → Lenin and Trotsky firmer
• GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled	• INTERVENTION → Reds claim defence of Russia	• GEOGRAPHY → central Russian core controlled

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OPPONENT → Whites divided in aim; INTERVENTION → Reds claim defence of Russia.

07

STAGE 07 — NEP BOUNDARY

NEP BOUNDARY | MARKET RETURNS | PEASANT SURPLUS AND SMALL TRADE | STATE RETAINS | HEAVY INDUSTRY, BANKS AND TRANSPORT | COMMUNIST MONOPOLY CONTINUES | ECONOMIC RETREAT WITHOUT POLITICAL RETREAT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade	POLITICS → communist monopoly continues	MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade
STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport	VERDICT → economic retreat without political retreat	STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade	• POLITICS → communist monopoly continues	• MARKET RETURNS → peasant surplus and small trade
• STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport	• VERDICT → economic retreat without political retreat	• STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATE RETAINS → heavy industry, banks and transport.

08

STAGE 08 — STALIN'S RISE LADDER

STALIN'S RISE LADDER | GENERAL SECRETARY | ORGANISATIONAL NETWORK | UNDERESTIMATE STALIN | SHIFTING ALLIANCES | TROTSKY ISOLATED FIRST | KAMENEV, ZINOVIEV AND BUKHARIN REMOVED

GENERAL SECRETARY → organisational network → RIVALS → underestimate Stalin → SHIFTING ALLIANCES → Trotsky isolated first → END → Kamenev, Zinoviev and Bukharin removed

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• GENERAL SECRETARY → organisational network	• SHIFTING ALLIANCES → Trotsky isolated first	• GENERAL SECRETARY → organisational network
• RIVALS → underestimate Stalin	• END → Kamenev, Zinoviev and Bukharin removed	• RIVALS → underestimate Stalin

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SHIFTING ALLIANCES → Trotsky isolated first; END → Kamenev, Zinoviev and Bukharin removed.

09

STAGE 09 — INDUSTRIALISATION AND COLLECTIVISATION

INDUSTRIALISATION AND COLLECTIVISATION | FIVE YEAR PLANS | HEAVY OUTPUT RISES | SCARCITY AND DISCIPLINE PERSIST | GRAIN CONTROL INCREASES | RURAL COST | RESISTANCE, LIVESTOCK LOSS AND FAMINE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises	COLLECTIVISATION → grain control increases	FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises
CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist	RURAL COST → resistance, livestock loss and famine	CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises	• COLLECTIVISATION → grain control increases	• FIVE YEAR PLANS → heavy output rises
• CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist	• RURAL COST → resistance, livestock loss and famine	• CONSUMPTION → scarcity and discipline persist

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RURAL COST → resistance, livestock loss and famine.

10

STAGE 10 — CONSTITUTION AND TERROR

CONSTITUTION AND TERROR | 1936 CONSTITUTION | DEMOCRATIC APPEARANCE | ONE PARTY | NO REAL ELECTORAL COMPETITION | STALIN BECOMES UNCHALLENGEABLE | CAPABILITY COST | OFFICERS AND OFFICIALS REMOVED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
1936 CONSTITUTION → democratic appearance	PURGES → Stalin becomes unchallengeable	1936 CONSTITUTION → democratic appearance
ONE PARTY → no real electoral competition	CAPABILITY COST → officers and officials removed	ONE PARTY → no real electoral competition

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• 1936 CONSTITUTION → democratic appearance	• PURGES → Stalin becomes unchallengeable	• 1936 CONSTITUTION → democratic appearance
• ONE PARTY → no real electoral competition	• CAPABILITY COST → officers and officials removed	• ONE PARTY → no real electoral competition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PURGES → Stalin becomes unchallengeable; CAPABILITY COST → officers and officials removed.

11

STAGE 11 — REVOLUTION-TO-STALIN ANSWER SPINE

REVOLUTION-TO-STALIN ANSWER SPINE | UNRESOLVED 1905 ORDER PLUS WAR | DUAL POWER AND ORGANISED OCTOBER | DECREE, COERCION, CIVIL WAR AND NEP | INDUSTRY, COLLECTIVISATION AND TERROR

COLLAPSE → unresolved 1905 order plus war → SEIZURE → dual power and organised October → CONSOLIDATION → decree, coercion, Civil War and NEP → TRANSFORMATION → industry, collectivisation and terror

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• COLLAPSE → unresolved 1905 order plus war	• CONSOLIDATION → decree, coercion, Civil War and NEP	• COLLAPSE → unresolved 1905 order plus war
• SEIZURE → dual power and organised October	• TRANSFORMATION → industry, collectivisation and terror	• SEIZURE → dual power and organised October

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSOLIDATION → decree, coercion, Civil War and NEP.

E

EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | GEORGE KATKOV STRESSES ELITE CONSPIRACY AND ABDICATION FROM ABOVE | W. H. CHAMBERLIN STRESSES A LEADERLESS, SPONTANEOUS UPRISING FROM | LATER HISTORIANS HIGHLIGHTED WORKERS' MATERIAL GRIEVANCES MORE THAN PARTY | DISPERSED THE CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY | JUSTIFIED EXECUTIONS AND COERCION | BANNED FACTIONALISM WITHIN THE PARTY. | "SOCIALISM IN ONE COUNTRY" VERSUS "PERMANENT REVOLUTION":

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- George Katkov stresses elite conspiracy and abdication from above;
- W. H. Chamberlin stresses a leaderless, spontaneous uprising from below;
- later historians highlighted workers' material grievances more than party direction.
- dispersed the Constituent Assembly;

ADVANCED DEBATE

- justified executions and coercion;
- banned factionalism within the party.
- "socialism in one country" versus "permanent revolution";
- continuation of NEP versus rapid industrialization.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Robert Conquest offers very high estimates;
- official post-Soviet data suggest lower but still enormous totals;
- Ronald Suny's wider counting pushes the destroyed lives still higher when famine is included.
- "Inevitable revolution" is a historiographical question, not a settled factual statement.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels